them, and Mr. Akerman told me the table in *Maitland's Survey* was authentic. The amount of it is £52 5s. 8d. a year. There are other donations mentioned by Maitland, amounting to sixty-four stone of beef, and five dozen of bread.

To these he adds the donation of "Robert Dow, who left £1 6s. 8d. yearly for ever to the sexton or bellman of St. Sepulchre's, to pronounce solemnly two exhortations to the persons condemned, the night before their execution; in these words:

"You prisoners who are within
Who for wickedness and sin,

after many mercies shown you, are now appointed to die to-morrow in the forenoon, give ear and understand that to-morrow morning the greatest bell of St. Sepulchre's shall toll for you in form and manner of a passing bell as used to be tolled for those that are at the point of death, to the end that all godly people may pray, etc., etc."

Here I cannot forbear mentioning a practice which probably had its origin from the ancient mode of torture, though now it seems only a matter of form. When prisoners capitally convicted at the Old Bailey are brought up to receive sentence, and the judge asks, "What have you to say why judgment of death and execution should not be awarded against you," the executioner slips a whipcord noose about their thumbs. This custom ought to be abolished.

At my visit in 1779, the gaol was clean, and free from offensive scents. On the felons' side, there were only three sick, in one of the upper wards. An infirmary was building near the condemned cells. Of the one hundred and forty-one felons, etc., there were ninety-one convicts and fines, who had only the prison allowance of a penny loaf a day. Mr. Akerman generously contributed towards their relief. In the felons' court, the table of fees painted on a board was hung up.

This gaol was burnt by the rioters[1] in 1780, but is rebuilt on the same plan. The men's quadrangle is now divided into three courts. In the first court, are those who pay three shillings and sixpence a week for a bed; in the next, the poorer felons; and in the other, now the women. Under the chapel, are cells for the refractory. Two rooms, adjoining to the condemned cells, are built for an infirmary, in one of which at my last visit there were sixteen sick. Of the two hundred and

[1] The riots mentioned here and elsewhere were the Gordon Riots. See *Barnaby Rudge*.—[Ed.]

ninety-one prisoners in 1782, two hundred and twenty-five were men, and sixty-six women. Upwards of a hundred of them were transports, eighty-nine fines, twenty-one under sentence of death, and the remainder lay for trial. Some of the condemned had been long sick, and languishing in their cells.[1]

TABLE OF FEES

London sc. A TABLE of FEES to be taken by the gaoler or keeper of Newgate within the said City of London for any prisoner or prisoners committed or coming into gaol or chamber-rent there or discharge from thence in any civil action settled and established the nineteenth day of December in the third year of the reign of his Majesty King George the Second *Annoque Domini* 1729 pursuant to an Act of Parliament lately made intituled An Act for the Relief of Debtors with respect to the Imprisonment of their Persons.

	£	s.	d.
Every prisoner on the master-side shall pay to the keeper for his entrance fee	0	3	0
Every prisoner on the master-side shall pay for chamber-room, use of bed, bedding and sheets to the keeper there being two in a bed and no more each per week . .	0	1	3
Every prisoner on the said master-side who at his own desire shall have a bed to himself, shall pay to the keeper for chamber-room, use of bed, bedding and sheets per week	0	2	6
Every debtor shall pay to the keeper for his discharging fee	0	6	10
And to all the turnkeys two shillings and no more . .	0	2	0

No other fee for the use of chamber bed bedding or sheets or upon the commitments or discharge of any prisoner on any civil action.

Edwd. Becher — ROBT. RAYMOND
Robt. Alsop — R. EYRE
Jno. Barnard — THOS. PENGELLY.

Mr. Akerman showed me another table of fees, which was given him for his direction when he commenced keeper. It is as follows:

FEES to be taken by the keeper of Newgate

	£	s.	d.
For every debtor's discharge	0	8	10
For every felon's discharge	0	18	10
For every misdemeanour	0	14	10

[1] An execution day is too much, with us, a day of riot and idleness, and it is found by experience, that the minds of the populace are rather hardened by the spectacle, than affected in any salutary manner. Might not these evils be amended by having the report within a week after sentence, and the execution soon after, either in the area before Newgate, or before the sessions-house?

Since the above was written, I learn with satisfaction that the place of execution is altered according to the foregoing idea.